

with automatic and manual modes. It's a bonus for beginners given there's a huge support community available on the Blender website to get you started!

3) HITFILM EXPRESS

Available on Windows and Mac OS, this includes not only basic content and film editing, it also performs basic colour correction along with professional grade FX. High-speed FX making, compositing (2D and 3D), limitless tracking and a video editor professional enough to integrate your workflow.

4) NATRON

Uniquely, Natron is an application which is node-based, specialising in real time compositing. It comes with over 250 ready-made utilisable plug-ins. This is a cross platform software too, so the OS isn't an issue. The only drawback is that it does not support anything 3D and can only go as far 2D and 2.5D effects.

5) BUTTLE OFX

Another open-source compositing software but it's available only for Linux, free to use. It enables both photo and video visual effects. The main goal of ButtleOFX was to make it user friendly and simple while at the same time being effective. It offers a very streamlined user experience with features like a dedicated effects interface, a parameters editor and a graph editor that enables users to connect nodes.

All of these free software are a good start for anyone interested in video editing/effects without wanting to spend a buck. While learning these might not help with using the more advanced, paid software, it will help to learn the basics and understand some of the basic things in the user interface which can be translated to other software as well.

PREMIUM ALTERNATIVE APPLICATIONS – ARE THEY WORTH IT?

1) FUSION 16

Blackmagic Design is by far the number one contender on this list. Fusion 16 is way more advanced than Adobe AE and testament to this fact is that it is used in Hollywood and film-makers all over the world. Films, television programs, commercials, it's everywhere. So what makes it so special?

3D animation specialist – with a node-based interface, it gives you access to a large number of tools including VR and 3D support. Going beyond video